

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage in Buddhism: divergent understandings of the significance of marriage in Buddhist life; divergent Buddhist teachings about marriage, including its importance, the Sigalovada Sutta, and the possible ideal of celibacy; divergent non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and the Buddhist responses to these attitudes.
2.2	Sexual relationships: Buddhist teachings about the nature and importance of sexual relationships, including reference to the Third Precept, Cunda Kammaraputta Sutta; different attitudes to celibacy, for example Jodo Shinshu monks; divergent Buddhist teachings and attitudes towards sexual relationships outside of marriage and same-sex sexual relationships; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Buddhist responses to them.
2.3	Buddhist teaching about the purpose and importance of the family: Buddhist teaching about the purpose of families, including the Sigalovada Sutta; Buddhist responses to the different types of family within 21st-century society (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the sangha, including the role of the sangha as a refuge as taught in The Khuddakapatha 1: how and why the community tries to support families, including through worship, rites of passage, festivals and counselling; divergent understandings of the importance of this support for Buddhists today.
2.5	Buddhist teaching on contraception: divergent Buddhist teachings and attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to The Natural World by XIV Dalai Lama; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories such as situation ethics and Buddhist responses to them.
2.6	Buddhist teachings about divorce: divergent Buddhist beliefs, teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage, including A Happy Married Life: A Buddhist Perspective by Ven. K. Sri Dhammananda; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Buddhist responses to them.
2.7	Buddhist teachings and attitudes about the equality of men and women in the family: divergent Buddhist beliefs, teachings and attitudes about the role of men and women in the family, including reference to the life of the Buddha and Sigalovada Sutta.
2.8	Buddhist teachings and attitudes about gender prejudice and discrimination, including the Soma Sutta: Buddhist opposition to gender prejudice and discrimination; examples of gender equality in action in Buddhism.

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	Meditation: the nature, purpose and significance of meditation in Buddhism; the different types of meditation: samatha (concentration), metta bhavana (loving kindness) and vipassana (insight); meditative practices, including mindfulness breathing and zazen, divergent understanding of the nature and importance of visualisation of the Buddha and Bodhisattvas, including Amitāyus Meditation Sutra; how the different practices are used by Mahayana and Theravada Buddhists and the benefits from their use.
3.2	Chanting: the nature, purpose and role of chanting in Buddhism as a devotional practice and to gain mental concentration, including Dhammapada 1–2, confidence and joy. The divergent understandings of the importance of chanting in Buddhist life today: Theravada Buddhism, including Tiratana Buddhism, with reference to Dhammapada 190, and Mahayana Buddhism, including Nam Myoho Renge Kyo.
3.3	Mantra recitation: divergent understandings of the nature, purpose, role and importance of mantra recitation with reference to Theravada Buddhism, including Namo Buddhaya ('Homage to the Buddha'), and Mahayana Buddhism; the nature and purpose of using sacred syllables, devotional articles, offerings and mala beads and why they are used in different schools of Buddhism.
3.4	Features of Buddhist places of worship: the divergent nature, history and design of Buddhist places of worship, including temples, gompas, viharas, shrines in Theravada, Mahayana and Triratna Buddhism; how and why the places of worship are used, including reference to the shrine room, shrine facing east, and the library, showing the importance of learning with reference to the Kimsila Sutta.
3.5	How and why objects of devotion are used within different Buddhist places of worship, buddharupas, including reference to Vakkali Sutta, shrine, Bodhi tree; divergent understandings of why devotional objects are important in Buddhism today.
3.6*	Puja: the nature and purpose of puja in the vihara and the home, including reference to Mangala Sutta; examples of the different types; when each type might be used and why; the importance of having different types of worship and their use in different Buddhist contexts.
3.7	Death and mourning rituals and ceremonies: the divergent celebration and significance of the ceremonies in Buddhist communities and to Buddhists; the distinct significance of the rituals associated with death and mourning in Theravada communities and in Japan and Tibet, with reference to the Tibetan Book of the Dead.
3.8	Festivals and retreats: the divergent nature, history, purpose and importance of festivals and retreats in Buddhism; divergent understandings of the origins, meaning and features of celebration of specific festivals and retreats, including Wesak, Vassa/Rain Retreat and Kathina, with reference to the Anapanasati Sutta, and Uposatha days in Theravada Buddhism; Hanamatsuri and Obon (Japanese), Parinibbana Day in Mahayana Buddhism, and Lama Tsong Khapa Day in Tibet.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Buddhist teachings about the origins and value of the universe: Buddhist responses to scientific explanations for the origins of the universe, including the origins having no significance and reference to <i>The Universe in a Single Atom</i> Chapter 4 by the XIV Dalai Lama; the value of the universe and the natural world in Buddhism; divergent Buddhist responses to and teachings on the possible view that the universe is to be used as a commodity.
4.2	Buddhist teachings about the sanctity of life, including reference to the First Precept in The Khuddakapatha: Buddhist teachings about why human life is special; how life is shown as special in Buddhism; divergent understandings regarding the importance of life for Buddhists today.
4.3	Buddhist responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins and value of human life, including evolution and survival of the fittest, including interpretations of Cula-Malunkya Sutta; divergent understandings of the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Buddhists today.
4.4	Implications of the Buddhist teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: divergent Buddhist teachings about the nature and use of abortion, including the First Precept and New York Times Interview with the Dalai Lama Sunday, December 5, 1993; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Buddhist responses to them.
4.5	Buddhist responses to the existence of death and the afterlife: Buddhist teachings and beliefs that support the existence of a life after death, including the Wheel of Life and the impermanence of the self, including reference to Sahasodgata Avadana, Divyavadana 21; divergent Buddhist responses to arguments for life after death (including remembered lives, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones); the significance of arguments for belief in life after death for Buddhists.
4.6	Buddhist responses to non-religious arguments against life after death: why Buddhists reject arguments against belief in life after death (including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts, social control), including Brahmajala Sutta 4.
4.7	Implications of Buddhist teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: Buddhist teachings about the nature and use of euthanasia including Vakkali Sutta; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Buddhist responses to them including support for hospice care, including the Buddhist Hospice Trust.
4.8	Buddhist responses to issues in the natural world: Buddhist teachings and responses to threats to the world, including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources, including Dhammapada 270 and The Buddhist Declaration on Nature (Assisi 1986); divergent Buddhist responses to animal rights, animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, including the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.